

Q&A

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The infamous HP incompatible cartridge issue strikes, along with creepy shutdowns and BIOS issues.

Tips & Tricks

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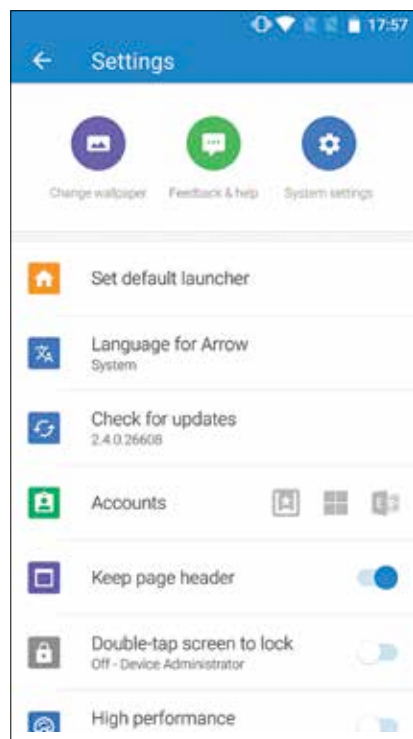
Our tips to supercharge your Android Browsing experience and audio editing tips for Audacity

Workshop

The other menus also offer many other tiny customisations that together come out beautiful, and you may end up investing a lot of time in tweaking the launcher. Once you're done, you can take backups of the entire setting and restore whenever you shift to a new phone or custom ROM, or after a factory reset.

Arrow

Coming from Microsoft Garage, Arrow takes over your homescreen and presents an organised space, efficiently reducing the number of steps required for many tasks. The most attractive feature here is the Recent screen, where all the recent apps, photos and documents you opened appear in a list. It takes care of the initial setup on its own, and then you'll be presented with five home screens. Initially, the Recent tab won't show much, but as you use your phone more, the tab will get populated with more content. Another interesting thing is the pull up menu on the homescreen that works similar to Apple's Control Center. The Reminders widget will let you directly add tasks on the homescreen and you will receive corresponding alerts. And



if you're a regular user of Wunderlist, the launcher has official support to link all your tasks here. On the customisation side, you won't see many options and we aren't complaining since it's not what the launcher is intended to do.

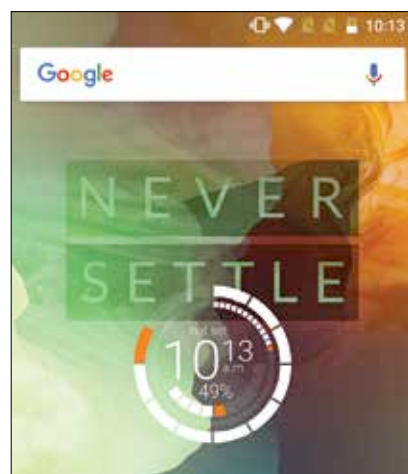
Yahoo Aviate

Just like Arrow, Aviate is also dedicated towards productivity and organising your apps, and to make your app drawer look better. Rather than having your apps listed alphabetically, Aviate organises them into categories such as productivity, social, transport, entertainment, etc. The initial setup lets you pick your favourite apps and then the next screen asks for your preferred categories. After the setup is complete, you'll be presented with two app drawers – one organised according to categories while the other one is listed alphabetically. The apps which are already installed in your phone will be automatically bundled in these categories. These categories also have a drop-down list that further suggests related apps with direct links to the Play Store. Coming to the other great feature in Aviate called Smart Stream, which is uncannily similar to Google Now, it takes advantage of only your location and activity to serve you relevant content. The launcher isn't really flexible with other customisations for your homescreen, and the categorisation is its only important feature.

Widgets

Acting as quick access window to an app, widgets get things done quicker while making your homescreen look good as well. There are widgets for almost every app, let it be weather updates, music player, calendar, etc. Usually, apps have their own widgets, but there are certain standalone widgets that connect to existing services on your phone. Our recommendations are as follow:

- Battery Widget Reborn
- Calendar Widget: Month
- Power Toggles
- Zooper



Iconpacks

Your phone has a lot of apps installed and they don't have a uniform shape or design, sometimes making your app drawer or homescreen look like a mess. This is where iconpacks are a boon. There are a lot of options to choose from and really good looking ones, both available in free and paid versions. For starters, we would recommend free ones and once you're familiar with using them, you'll automatically head out to search for the best in the premium segment. One thing to note is that iconpacks need a third-party launcher. The support for launchers depends on every iconpack but you'll be fine with popular launchers such as Nova, Apex, and Aviate etc. You can find many on the Play Store by simply entering 'iconpacks' in the search field. Here are a few picks from our side on the minimal front:

- Candycon
- Delta - Icon Pack
- Glim
- Moonshine
- Polycon

Theme Managers

Now that we've dealt with the customisations possible in non-rooted phones, it's time we moved on to rooted phones. From this point, we expect you to already have a rooted phone with the stock or a custom ROM installed. If you're on the stock ROM, then you'll have to install a third-party theme engine using Xposed but with Cyano-